



FLIP THROUGH BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD

# The AI Instructions File

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files,  
plus everything the full download includes.



## THE PROBLEM

### Two ways an AI wastes your evening

Both are avoidable, and both come from the same missing page.

#### One: it asks instead of deciding

"Would you like the buttons rounded or square?" "Should the timer count up or down?" "Do you want this centered?"

**You do not care.** You have no opinion, you have never had an opinion, and being asked forces you to invent one. Ten of those and the thing you were excited to build has turned into paperwork.

#### Two: it drifts

Round one is exactly what you wanted. By round six it has quietly added a login screen, a settings page and a place to type student names — because that is what most software looks like, and nobody told it otherwise.

**Drift is not the model being careless.** It is the model filling silence with the most common answer. The fix is to stop being silent about the things you actually care about.

#### Both are the same missing thing

You are holding the whole picture in your head, and the AI can only see this one message. **The instructions file is your head, written down, and is the cheapest thing you will ever do for a build.**

**SNEAK PEEK · 5 pages**

## What goes in it – a real one, not a template

This is a genuine instructions file from one of my own classroom projects. Five short sections, and none of them is about code.

### 1. What this is, in one sentence

```
A [kind of thing] for [who uses it]. Read [the other doc]
before doing anything. That doc is the source of truth.
```

One sentence. If you cannot write it, that is worth knowing before you start building.

### 2. Non-negotiables – the things it may never do

- Never use the words battle, fight or enemy in anything a player reads.
- No student names anywhere, in code or on screen.
- Every question at real high school level, with a hint.

This section is the whole file. Write the rules that you say "No, not like that" — before you have to say it.

### 3. The stack, and why

```
Plain JavaScript, no framework, no build step. Serve it
with any static server. It must run on Chromebooks and
phones. Touch controls are required, not optional.
```

"No framework, no build step" is the line that keeps you out of a terminal. Worth writing every time.

### 4. Where things live, and 5. how to behave

A short map of the files, so a new chat does not reorganize your project. Then the working rules:

- Do not start the next stage until the last one works.
- Keep PROGRESS.md updated at the end of every session.
- Short, warm, dry writing. No em dashes anywhere.

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## The one sentence that saves the evening

If you put nothing else in the file, put this.

**"When a design question is genuinely open, make the obvious choice and write it down, rather than stopping to ask."**

### What it does

It gives the AI permission to decide the hundred small things you have no opinion about — and it makes every one of those decisions **visible and reversible**, because it has to be written down. You get the speed of not being asked without losing the ability to say "actually, not that."

### The half that makes it safe

"Write it down" means a running notes file. Mine is one page, updated at the end of every session:

DONE the map screen, three routes, keyboard controls  
 NEXT camps and gear  
 OPEN chose three roads, not four  
 KNOWN the sound is too much

**SNEAK PEEK · 5 pages**

That file is how you pick a project back up after a week of teaching without rereading everything. It is also how you catch a decision you disagree with, one line at a time, instead of discovering it in round twelve.

### Where the line does not apply

A genuinely open question is a shade of blue. A question about what your students see, what gets stored about them, or what the thing is for is **not open** — and a good non-negotiables section means it never has to be asked.



## WHAT IS INSIDE

# The AI Instructions File

- ✓ The two ways an AI wastes your evening
- ✓ A real instructions file from a live classroom project
- ✓ The one sentence that stops it asking and starts it deciding
- ✓ The running notes habit that lets you pick a build back up
- ✓ A fill-in page so you leave with your own

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